

February

26



1909

Kinemacolor

Motion pictures created using the first successful colour film process, Kinemacolor, were shown for the first time at the Palace Theatre in London, UK. Kinemacolor was invented by British filmmaker George Albert Smith.

Also on this day

1606 Dutch navigator **Willem Jansz** became the first European to land in Australia.

1935 **Radio Detection And Ranging (RADAR)** was first demonstrated by Scottish physicist Robert Alexander Watson-Watt, to detect aircraft.

2008 **The Svalbard Global Seed Vault**, which stores seeds of food crops from around the world, was opened. It was built inside a mountain on the remote Norwegian island of Spitsbergen.

1616



Galileo silenced

The Roman Catholic Church banned Italian astronomer Galileo Galilei from teaching and sharing his theory that Earth orbits the Sun. At the time it was believed that Earth was at the centre of the Solar System.

Born this day

1829 **Levi Strauss**, German-born US entrepreneur. He set up the first jeans company to mass-produce the casual trousers made from denim, and patented the design of blue jeans.

1919 Grand Canyon

US president Woodrow Wilson signed an Act of Congress to make the Grand Canyon in Arizona an official national park. Today, this giant canyon, carved out by the Colorado River, receives about 6 million visitors a year.

